

Station 1: Spot the Challenge

Grade 5 Writing

8 minutes

Target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.

Materials: Pencil; optional highlighter

Read

During the last ten minutes of class, Maya reached into her desk for the novel her group was discussing. The book was not there. She checked her backpack twice and looked under her chair. Her group was already opening to the assigned chapter.

Maya wanted to ask the teacher for another copy, but first she tried to remember the last place she had used the book. She pictured herself reading during indoor recess near the art shelves. Maya quietly told her group she would be right back, asked permission to check the shelves, and found the novel beside a box of colored pencils. She returned before the group finished its first question.

Do

1. What challenge does Maya face?
2. List two things Maya does in response to the challenge.
3. Which sentence best explains Maya's response? Circle one.
 - A. She ignores the problem and waits for someone else to solve it.
 - B. She thinks about where the book might be and takes steps to find it.
 - C. She becomes angry with her group for starting without her.
 - D. She decides she no longer needs the book.

Station 2: Put the Response in Order

Grade 5 Writing

8 minutes

Target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.

Materials: Pencil

Read

Nia's class was testing small bridges made from craft sticks. When Nia placed the third book on her bridge, one side bent and the center dropped onto the table. For a moment, Nia stared at the broken bridge. She had expected it to hold at least five books.

Instead of throwing the bridge away, Nia looked closely at the part that had failed. She noticed two sticks had separated where there was very little glue. She sketched the weak spot on her recording sheet, added a second stick across each side joint, and waited for the glue to dry. On the next test, her bridge held four books before bending.

Do

1. State Nia's challenge in one sentence.

2. Number these response steps from 1 to 4.

___ She adds support to the weak joints.

___ She looks closely at where the bridge failed.

___ She tests the bridge again.

___ She records the weak spot.

3. In one phrase, describe Nia's overall response to the challenge.

Station 3: When the Plan Changes

Target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.
Materials: Pencil

Read

Luis and his partner had planned to give their plant-growth presentation beside the school garden. They had labeled the rows and practiced pointing out which plants grew best in shade. Ten minutes before the presentation, heavy rain began. The class could not go outside.

Luis frowned at the dark windows, then opened the photo folder on the class tablet. He and his partner chose four pictures they had taken during the week. Luis drew a quick map of the garden on chart paper and added arrows showing where each photo had been taken. When it was their turn, they used the photos and map to explain the same observations they had planned to show outdoors.

Do

Original plan	Challenge	Response
Present beside the school garden.	Write the challenge here.	Write two actions Luis takes.

2. Why does Luis's response solve the problem?

Station 4: Same Challenge, Different Responses

Target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.
Materials: Pencil

Read

On a class nature walk, the group reached a trail that was blocked by a large fallen branch. The teacher told everyone to stay together while the adults checked the area.

Marcus sighed and sat on a nearby rock. He said the walk was probably over and stopped looking at the trail map. Ava studied the map with another student. She noticed a marked loop that joined the main trail farther ahead. Ava pointed it out to the teacher and asked whether the class could use that route. After an adult checked the loop, the class continued the walk.

Do

Character	How the character responds	Text detail that proves it
Marcus		
Ava		

2. What is one important difference between Marcus's response and Ava's response?

Station 5: Match the Evidence

Grade 5 Writing

8 minutes

Target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.

Materials: Pencil

Read

Mei had practiced the first part of her speech many times, but when she stood in front of the class, her mind went blank. She looked down at her note card and could not find the line she wanted. A few seconds felt much longer.

Mei took one slow breath and found the heading she had written in large letters. She used the heading to remember her next idea. Then she looked at her teacher, who nodded, and continued speaking. Mei still checked her note card more than she had planned, but she finished the speech and answered one question from the audience.

Do

1. What challenge does Mei face?

2. Put a check beside every detail that shows Mei responding to the challenge.

- ☐ She takes one slow breath.
- ☐ She had practiced the first part many times.
- ☐ She uses the large heading to remember her next idea.
- ☐ Her teacher nods.
- ☐ She continues speaking.
- ☐ A few seconds feel much longer.

3. Use one checked detail to complete the sentence: **Mei responds to the challenge by...**

Station 6: Explain the Response

Grade 5 Writing

8 minutes

Target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.

Materials: Pencil; optional highlighter

Read

Sam had promised his younger cousin that they would finish a cardboard arcade game before the family picnic. On Saturday morning, Sam discovered that the marble kept rolling off the ramp before reaching the target cup. The picnic was that afternoon.

Sam tested the ramp three more times and watched where the marble left the track. He folded two thin strips of cardboard and taped them along the sides like rails. The marble stayed on the ramp but moved too slowly, so Sam raised the top of the ramp using a small stack of scrap cardboard. On the next test, the marble rolled between the rails and dropped into the cup. Sam called his cousin over to try it.

Write

1. In 3-4 complete sentences, explain Sam's challenge and how he responds to it. Use at least **two details** from the story.

2. Underline the sentence in your response that most clearly identifies how Sam responds.